

# Carotid Body Resection/Carotid Body Denervation

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## Tracking Information

### Publication Number

100-3

### Manual Section Number

20.18

### Manual Section Title

Carotid Body Resection/Carotid Body Denervation

### Version Number

1

### Effective Date of this Version

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

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## Description Information

### Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

**Please Note:** This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

### Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Carotid body resection is occasionally used to relieve pulmonary symptoms, including asthma, but has been shown to lack general acceptance of the professional medical community. In addition, controlled clinical studies establishing the safety and effectiveness of this procedure are needed. Therefore, all carotid body resections to relieve pulmonary symptoms must be considered investigational and cannot be considered reasonable and necessary within the meaning of section 1862(a)(1) of the Act. No program reimbursement may be made in such cases.

However, there is one instance where carotid body resection has been accepted by the medical community as effective. That instance is when evidence of a mass in the carotid

body, with or without symptoms, indicates the need for surgery to remove the carotid body tumor.

Denervation of a carotid sinus to treat hypersensitive carotid sinus reflex is another procedure performed in the area of the carotid body. In the case of hypersensitive carotid sinus, light pressure on the upper part of the neck (such as might be experienced when turning or raising one's head) results in symptoms such as dizziness or syncope due to hypotension and slowed heart rate. Failure of medical therapy and continued deterioration in the condition of the patient in such cases may indicate need for surgery.

Denervation of the carotid sinus is rarely performed, but when elected as the therapy of choice with the above indications, this procedure may be considered reasonable and necessary.

## Additional Information

Other Versions

| Title                                           | Version | Effective Between |  |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Carotid Body Resection/Carotid Body Denervation | 1       | 01/01/1966 - N/A  | You are here                                                                        |